GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

November 28th, 2025
Week 48
Volume 278, Issue 1213

Highlights:

- **First Pak HKC.**
- **21 up in Bangla.**
- **Lowly markets.**
- **Few ships.**
- **Focus firm.**
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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Worrying about something is a fantastic way to defeat imagination."

– Unknown

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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STUMPED, YET PRIMED!

Global market chaos continues post-Thanksgiving like a bad stomach after too much turkey. Steel plate prices were the highlight of the entire sub-continent—and even China—where they unanimously retreated in unison this week, while the U.S. Dollar also decided to join in on the fun as it too retreated at all sub-continent locations (except—no surprise—Turkey!). Making matters worse are the rising freight markets that continue to surprise the industry, as the Baltic Exchange's Dry Index climbed another 3.2% through the course of the week, hitting a new high since December 2023 as practically every segment assisted in with the rising rates. Oil, meanwhile, remains at 21st-century lows, idling with marginal fluctuations, yet it closed the week out at USD 59.16/Ton—a near 14% drop over the last 12 months.

As supply continues to be restricted by the widening net of sanctions and blacklists in addition to rising freight rates, it was still a kind gesture by the gods of tonnage that both Bangladesh and India mercifully reported fresh arrivals and deliveries at the waterfront, all while Pakistan's dithering local anchorage returned zilch this week. Prices too remain fragile amidst dreadful fundamentals that haven't gotten a chance to get off their respective trampolines, as most of the tonnage introduced to the markets is either an off-market questionably sourced unit or smaller LDT units that are regularly seeing sub-USD 400/Ton from key locations, creating a dual-priced reality for the markets.

Yet in the midst of uncertainty, a momentous development unraveled this week with the first Pakistani ship-recycling yard to be awarded HKC compliance, as Prime Green Recyclers became the first in the nation to join the array of international yards—bringing Pakistan into the new league. Prime Recyclers attained Bureau Veritas (BV) blessings after the requisite investment and infrastructure upgrades spanning this past year bore fruit, and the matter became critical after the Hong Kong Convention came into force on June 26th. This follows on the heels of 21 Bangladeshi yards receiving their HKC accreditations and a 22nd yard set to reportedly follow imminently, as compliance is firmly underway at both locations to revolutionize and improve domestic standards and catch up to Alang, where over 100 yards have been HKC compliant—some practically for over a decade now.

Overall, as market fundamentals remain confidently uncertain, prices have endured a turbulent ride across the board over the last few months. USD 400/LDT+ remains a struggle to achieve in some markets as steel and currencies continue to underperform, alongside the deadly dearth of candidates that has plagued markets for about four years now, with only a handful of sales taking place to increasingly hungry recyclers—particularly in a resurgent Bangladesh, which led the way for sub-continent pricing for another week. Another four weeks and another trip around the sun means the industry continues hoping for a market resurgence in 2026. Tough year!

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 48 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

IN VOGUE!

HKC focus.

The focus in Bangladesh over the last five months has been clearly targeted at bringing domestic ship-recycling yards up to speed, with tremendous progress having been made on HKC infrastructure upgrade work. Twenty-one yards are now approved (under NK, IR, BV classes), and another yard has reportedly reached completion, taking the total to 22 set to follow shortly. While this is certainly encouraging news for the industry as a whole, on an individual basis the fractured state of supply continues to make ship recyclers at these yards wonder if such gratuitous expenses during a four-year spell of tonnage drought have been financially worth it, because at the end of the day, it's all dollars and cents.

Dollars and Cents

And deservedly so. The last four years have brought massive instability to the nation via skyrocketing and volatile inflation, a Bangladeshi Taka that has dragged local pricing down—collapsing from the highs of USD 600/Ton to USD 400/Ton since January 2024—political instability, national riots, uncontrollable monsoons, cheaper steel imports that have, for the first time, hammered local sentiments in unexpected ways, and local steel plate prices that are escaping down a chute like a bad dinner.

Work ongoing.

Speaking of local steel plate prices, they fell even further this week (as they have for several weeks now), dropping USD 11/Ton and closing the week at USD 506/Ton—a massive fall from above USD 600/Ton and now potentially approaching sub-USD 500/Ton through December. The Taka, on the contrary, managed to escape last week's fate, firming nearly 30 basis points and ending the week at BDT 122.08 against the U.S. Dollar.

Uncomfortable.

The nation's prevailing sentiments also continue to remain fragile as the interim government stays in a paralytic state, and tensions and bursts of local political violence remain scattered across the nation as the upcoming elections of February 2026 linger on the collective minds of the populace. Steel imports also continue to affect the resale values of recycled ships' steel that remains at local yards, even though incoming imports over the last couple of weeks indicate local resale movements and emptying plots that have respective yard owners eager to take in units. This week's anchorage certainly reflected that sentiment as a collection of various sub-10K units earmarked the waterfront.

Pricing meanwhile has managed to remain the most impressive in the sub-continent (although that isn't saying much given the quantum of declining levels across the industry), while levels over USD 400/LDT are regularly available for larger LDT, good-condition units, with smaller vessels generally taking the pricing brunt well below USD 400/LDT—if any interest were to arise at all. As such, the next quarter is certainly of interest to those with tonnage to sell

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

LOSING HOPE!

Below 400.

A lowly Alang market remains positioned below USD 400/LDT on most tonnage and is thus out of the picture for the collection of competitive vessels that have been making the rounds of late. Making matters even more challenging is their inability to negotiate effectively on HKC tonnage for select local yards, as Bangladesh is clearly catching up with a larger fraction of HKC yards—and even Pakistan finally entering the ring.

Diversions.

Indeed, even favored LNG vessels rich in non-ferrous (if MOSS type) have found their retirement spots in Bangladesh in recent times, so poor have levels from Alang been recently. Local anchorage, however, mercifully managed to take in their regular share of questionable tankers, which have been finding India a convenient location to offload.

What has been really affecting the local purchasing mindset are the key fundamentals: not only did the Indian Rupee plummet into the high INR 89s—despite firming 28 basis points against the U.S. Dollar this week and closing out at INR 89.35—but local steel plate prices fell USD 5/Ton this week, clocking out at USD 390/Ton.

Culprits.

Yet the Indian economy has been generating positive results, as the nation's GDP climbed 8.2% on the back of improvements in the construction and manufacturing sectors, prompting industry pundits to improve future growth prospects for the economy.

Even so, recycling remains in shambles as competing nations are comparatively higher placed and keep chipping into Alang's HKC share, while fundamentals affecting the nation's ship-recycling sector have clearly been the pricing culprits for this struggling market.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

FIRST HKC!

Big news!

This has truly been one of the most momentous weeks not only for Pakistan's ship-recycling sector, but also for the nation's ship-recycling future, as Prime Green Recyclers of Gadani have become the first HKC-approved facility in Pakistan, with BV announcing the momentous news this week.

This is a major milestone for the sector as it finally brings Gadani into the big leagues, and all it will take now is a willing group of shipowners and/or cash buyers to propose vessels locally and evaluate the efficacy of the upgrades and ensuing recycling processes. As several more yards are also undergoing HKC upgrades, it is likely we may see the next round of approvals come through reportedly within the next 3–4 months.

Others to follow.

Yet, like India, the nation's economy remains in a fragile state, as not only did local steel plate prices fall USD 7/Ton and wrap the week up at USD 579/Ton, but the Pakistani Rupee firmed a relatively minor 9 basis points and ended the week at PKR 282. While these numbers are certainly far better than those from competing India (helping the Gadani Gang maintain their position in the market rankings), the lack of HKC yards has punished Gadani's anchorage by ending another week with an utterly empty waterfront.

Status quo.

As such, it has remained a quiet week in terms of sales and activity, and with the bulk of the tonnage delivered into Bangladesh clearly opening up in the Far East and India taking in units, the future for Gadani across December will likely maintain the status quo.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

CHANGING TACTICS!!

Unstoppable.

The Lira's decline continues unabated as it fell 15 basis points and breached TRY 42.50 against the U.S. Dollar, as the Turkish government finally decided to step in and announce economic measures to curtail this seemingly unstoppable decline. Surprisingly, amidst inflation nearing 33%, GDP posted nearly 5% growth in the second quarter, easing some financial stresses for its citizens.

For Aliaga's citizens, however, the situation remains rather dim.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 48 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	260 / LDT	270 / LDT	280 / LDT

SPACED OUT!!

- ***Gamma-ray bursts release more energy in 10 seconds than our Sun in its entire life.*** *Nothing in the Universe rivals the power unleashed during a gamma-ray burst, a brief but incredibly intense flash of high-energy radiation. There are many types of gamma-ray burst. Some are thought to form when a massive star implodes; others when two neutron stars merge together.*
- ***There are stars we will never be able to see.*** *Ever since the Big Bang, most objects in space have been moving away from one another. In fact, the expansion of the Universe is actually accelerating. This is one of the facts about space that has really rocked the cosmological boat over the past few years, and it's known as dark energy. As regions of space are whizzing away from one another at an ever-increasing rate, the first population of stars to form in the Universe are now too far away for us to ever hope of spying them. And that's even using the best present or future telescope. Hope is not lost. We can attempt to spot them indirectly via the energetic bursts of radiation they emit at the end of their lives.*
- ***A day on Venus is longer than its year.*** *Venus has one of the slowest rotations in the Solar System. It takes about 243 Earth days to complete one full spin on its axis, but takes only 225 Earth days to orbit the Sun. This means a day on Venus – the time it takes to spin once – is longer than a year on Venus – the time it takes to orbit the Sun once. Even more bizarre, due to its 'backwards' spin, if you stood on the surface, the Sun would rise in the west and set in the east!*
- ***Black holes have theoretical opposites known as white holes.*** *Black holes are known for their voracious appetites; their influence is so strong that even light can't escape their gravity. But they have a theoretical converse – white holes. They are effectively the opposite of their dark relatives, spitting out light and matter instead of trapping it. So far, they are purely hypothetical objects; astronomers are contemplating how they could form in reality.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 24 – Christmas Eve December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – New Year's Eve	December 02 – December 10 December 18 – December 25

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 01 – 02 – Durga Puja December 16 – Victory Day December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – Bank Holiday	December 03 – December 06 December 21 – December 24

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
December 25 – Quaid-e-Azam	**No holidays in December**

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ALANG - Port Position as of November 28, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
2	*Kai De Star*	*2,665*	*Reefer*	*Delivered November 28*
3	*Sunflower*	*41,554*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered November 25*
4	*Zenith*	*17,013*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered November 28*
Total Tonnage		**81,234**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of November 28, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Nica	7,779	Bulk Carrier	Arrived November 25
2	Patcharawadee 10	1,295	LPG	Arrived November 24
3	Patcharawadee 12	1,244	LPG	Arrived November 24
4	Patcharawadee 14	2,450	LPG	Arrived November 24
5	Star Advance	9,691	Chemical Tanker	Arrived November 28
		22,459		

GADANI - Port Position as of November 28, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

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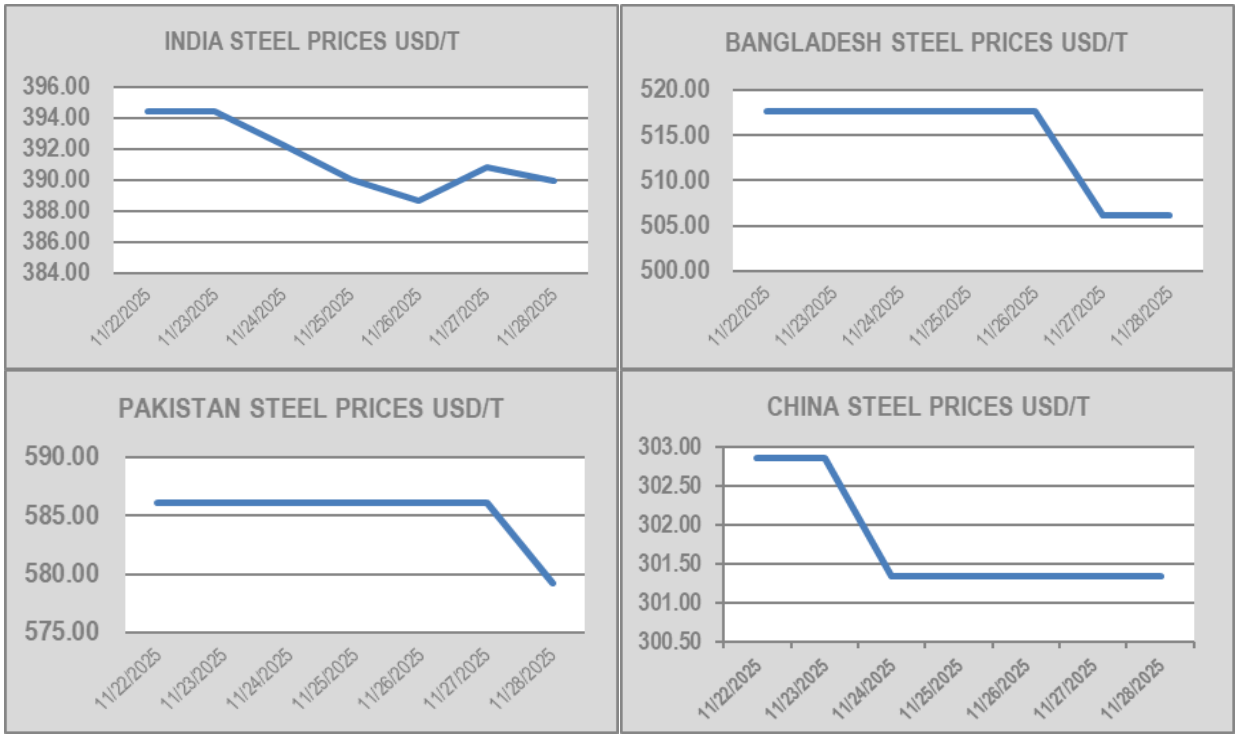
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
11/22/2025	394.41	35,300.00	586.15	165,000.00	517.70	62,900.00	302.86
11/23/2025	394.41	35,300.00	586.15	165,000.00	517.70	62,900.00	302.86
11/24/2025	392.24	35,000.00	586.15	165,000.00	517.70	62,900.00	301.35
11/25/2025	390.05	34,800.00	586.15	165,000.00	517.70	62,900.00	301.35
11/26/2025	388.71	34,700.00	586.15	165,000.00	517.70	62,900.00	301.35
11/27/2025	390.82	34,900.00	586.15	165,000.00	506.17	61,500.00	301.35
11/28/2025	389.99	34,900.00	579.25	163,000.00	506.17	61,500.00	301.35



www.gmsinc.net GMS_Leadership GMS Leadership snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311